Pakistan which affect the common Indo-Nepal security interests.

Indian officials believed that King Mahendra was a lonely man, ill-advised and ill-served by his ministers and officials and easily sent off at tangents every few weeks. This was evident from the king's rather strong comment when he arrived at Palam Airport on 18 April 1962, as recorded in a government dispatch:

We firmly believe that friendship is not a one-sided affair and friendly exchange of views is the best way to dispel imaginary or prospective misunderstanding between friends [...] that we keep ourselves ever ready for heart-to-heart talks with all friends for removing mutual misunderstanding.

While speaking at the banquet hosted in his honour on the same day, King Mahendra tried to pacify the Indian side, claiming that the Kingdom of Nepal was taking strides along the path of progress in response to the demand of the times.

But India was suspicious. Besides Nepal's relationship with China, India was also wary of the growing bonhomie between Pakistan and Nepal. IB operatives believed that Pakistan was trying to strengthen its base in this tiny, landlocked Himalayan country. Pakistan's president, Mohammad Ayub Khan, landed in Kathmandu on 9 May 1963 to cement ties between the two countries. Indian ambassador Harishwar Dayal in his note on 15 June 1963 said that Ayub Khan's visit appeared to have been intended not only as a return of the hospitality extended to King Mahendra in Pakistan earlier but as a reminder that Nepal had other friends besides India.